

**CUP OF LOVE: AN ANALYSIS OF HOW LOVE IS POTRAYED ON THE
SONGS OF CUP OF JOE**

A Research Paper Presented to the Faculty of

SENIOR HIGH SCHOOL

Notre Dame of Dadiangas University

Marist Avenue, General Santos City

In Partial Fulfilment of the Requirements for the Subject

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The researchers sincerely acknowledged and expressed their deepest appreciation to the individuals who demonstrated generosity and provided guidance that contributed to the completion of this qualitative research study. Despite the difficult and challenging moments encountered throughout the process; all efforts were realized through strong teamwork and collaboration. The researchers extended their gratitude to the research leader and her friends, for their unwavering support, encouragement, and assistance during the making of this paper.

To the research members, for their perseverance and valuable contributions in making this paper possible. To the researchers, beloved families, heartfelt gratitude was extended for their unconditional love, continuous support, and endless encouragement. These served as the foundation upon which the researchers built their resilience and determination. Through their sacrifices and belief in the researchers' capabilities, their families nurtured them to be confident, independent, and driven. This achievement are not only for researchers, but also a reflection of the stable presence of their family in their lives.

To **Ma'am Charisse P. Sumalinog**, the research expert, the researchers are immensely grateful for her expertise and dedication in ensuring the success of this study. Her unwavering support and insightful guidance were instrumental in refining the research, shaping its content, and strengthening its purpose. Her belief in the significance of the study motivated the researchers to strive for excellence.

To **Ma'am Jirah C. Dasalla** and **Sir Jared F. Medel**, the respected panelists, the researchers extended their appreciation for their guidance, encouragement, and keen supervision throughout this research journey. Although their roles were primarily evaluative, their dedication, constructive feedback, and motivation played a vital role in pushing the researchers forward. Their willingness to share their expertise made the experience both meaningful and enriching for the researchers.

To the band, **Cup of Joe**, the creative minds behind the songs released, the researchers are grateful for the resources given in order to analyze their music. Their music not only served as the subject of the study, but it fostered appreciation among researchers towards the production of Original Pinoy Music (OPM) and the realization of love as a universal feeling for every human being.

Finally, above all, to the Almighty God, the constant source of wisdom, strength, and inspiration. His guidance illuminated their path throughout this journey, granting them perseverance in times of difficulty and clarity in moments of uncertainty. Amidst the doubt and difficulty, His presence reassured them, filling them with courage and determination. This study would not have been possible without His countless blessings, and for that, they humbly give thanks. **To Him be all glory.**

The Researchers

DEDICATION

In heartfelt gratitude, the researchers dedicated this study to the following:

First and foremost, to Almighty God, the source of all wisdom and grace. Through His divine guidance, the researchers were blessed with the strength, perseverance, and clarity of mind to overcome the challenges encountered throughout the course of this study. They offered their deepest gratitude for the countless blessings that have led them to the successful completion of this work.

To the researchers' beloved families, whose unconditional love, constant support, and unwavering encouragement served as the pillars of their resilience and determination. Through their sacrifices and belief in the researchers' abilities, they nurtured them into confident, independent, and driven individuals. This accomplishment stood not only as the researchers' success but also as a reflection of their families' enduring presence in their lives.

To **Ma'am Shennei C. Abellanos**, the dedicated and passionate research adviser, the researchers expressed their sincerest appreciation. Her generosity in sharing her knowledge, patience in guiding them through the complexities of academic research, and consistent encouragement played a vital role in shaping the researchers' skills and strengthening our commitment to scholarly excellence. Her mentorship left a lasting impact on the researchers' academic journey.

To the band, **Cup of Joe**, the creative minds behind the songs analyzed in this study. Their music provided valuable material that made this research possible, serving as the foundation for examining themes and meanings within contemporary OPM. Beyond being the subject of analysis, their songs also inspired a deeper appreciation for the artistry and creativity involved in producing Original Pinoy Music (OPM). Through their meaningful lyrics and emotional depth, the researchers recognized love as a universal experience that transcended individual differences and connected people through shared feelings and human experiences.

To the Notre Dame of Dadiangas University – Integrated Basic Education Department Senior High School (NDDU - IBED SHS), the researchers expressed their sincere gratitude for providing them with the platform and resources necessary to conduct this research. The institution's commitment to fostering academic growth and intellectual curiosity among its students has empowered them to pursue knowledge with passion and purpose.

To future researchers who would continue to cultivate a deeper sense of nationalism, the researchers hoped that this study would serve as both a guide and an inspiration. May it encourage further exploration of Filipino culture, language, and music, and foster a greater appreciation for local artistry. Through continued research, future scholars could contribute to the preservation and promotion of Original Pinoy Music (OPM) while strengthening national identity and pride.

Lastly, for the Filipino youth, the researchers offered this study as a reflection of the richness and depth of our culture, particularly through music. May it inspire a greater appreciation for Original Pinoy Music (OPM) and encourage individuals to recognize the beauty of expressing emotions, especially love, through our own language and artistry. The researchers hoped that this work contributed to a stronger sense of identity, unity, and pride among Filipinos, reminding us of the shared experiences and values that connect us as a nation.

The Researchers

ABSTRACT

This study analyzed how love is portrayed in selected songs by Cup of Joe within the context of contemporary Filipino music and culture. Love is approached as a complex concept expressed through emotional, psychological, and cultural perspectives. Using content analysis guided by formalism, Lee's Love Styles Theory, and cultural theory, the study analyzes imagery, diction, tone, and repetition in the lyrics of ten selected songs to identify dominant forms of love—Eros, Agape, and Mania—and recurring themes of steadfast affection, sentimental reflection, and lingering presence. Coding sheets were employed to systematically organize patterns, with the analysis focusing solely on lyrical content. The findings had shown that the songs not only depict universal emotional experiences such as loyalty, nostalgia, and longing but also reflect distinctly Filipino values, including belief in destiny (*tadhana*), self-sacrifice (*sakripisyo*), and traditional courtship (*panliligaw*). Overall, the study demonstrated that Cup of Joe's songs function as both artistic and cultural texts, emphasized how music can shape emotional expression and reinforce cultural identity among Filipino youth. By analyzing the lyrics through theoretical and qualitative approaches, the study contributed to a deeper understanding of how OPM communicates love, emotional experiences, and social values. It also emphasized the value of examining song lyrics as literary texts, which can be applied in education, cultural studies, and future research on contemporary Filipino music and youth culture.

Keywords: ***Love styles, Original Pilipino Music (OPM), Cup of Joe, content analysis, lyrical analysis, Filipino culture, themes of love, formalism, cultural theory***

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CHAPTER I

INTRODUCTION

Love is a complex and fluid concept that resisted a single, fixed definition. It encompassed abstract ideals such as justice, freedom, or spirituality, as well as everyday human experiences like friendship, intimacy, and romantic relationships. Because of its multifaceted nature, love can be understood through multiple lenses, including philosophical, socio-cultural, and psychological approaches. While psychological interpretations tend to dominate contemporary discussions—focusing on attachment, emotional regulation, and interpersonal dynamics—philosophical perspectives remain essential for exploring love's ethical, moral, emotional, and relational dimensions (2024).

(Palmer, 2026) stated that music helps us understand love in a personal and emotional way. There were emotions we never wanted to acknowledge or think about, and music allowed us to find comfort within our minds as we can hold onto a note and hang onto it until it reaches the end of the song. Through music, people were able to express feelings they could not easily say in words, especially feelings about love, heartbreak, longing, and hope. Songs often reflected our own experiences in relationships, helping us feel less alone. In this way, music becomes a space where love and emotions met, allowing people to understand their feelings more deeply and honestly.

In contemporary Filipino society, love was deeply embedded within cultural norms and social practices. The Philippines, known for its strong family-oriented values and collectivist culture, often emphasized relational harmony, loyalty, and community in expressions of love. Papinczak et al. (2015) emphasizes the role of music in shaping the youth's understanding of love. As a result, music does not merely entertain—it actively influenced how young Filipinos understood, felt, and practiced love in everyday life. the pursuit of lifelong partnerships.

Within the contemporary Original Pilipino Music (OPM) scene, love remained a dominant and recurring theme. Popular bands, such as Cup of Joe, frequently explored emotional experiences associated with longing, vulnerability, connection, and relational conflict. Cup of Joe, in particular, has achieved significant commercial and cultural success. An article published by GMA Integrated News (2025) The band topped the *Billboard Philippines Hot 100* for 27 consecutive weeks with their viral hit “Multo” and was named *Billboard Philippines’ No. 1 Artist of the Year* in 2025. With over ten million monthly listeners on Spotify, the band wields considerable influence among Filipino youth, who often engage with their music as both a mirror of personal emotional experiences and a lens through which to imagine idealized relationships.

Mainstream Filipino music was often portrayed in idealized ways that placed greater emphasis on romance, which overlooked the complexity and responsibilities in relationships. Idealized love referred to portrayals that romanticized emotional depth and destiny while minimizing the complexities and responsibilities inherent in relationships. According to Malcampo and Manalili (2025), Filipino Generation Z’s ideals of romance are shaped by diverse influences, including media portrayals, societal, cultural norms, and personal experiences. This suggested that social media and popular media contributes to romanticized notions of love, these ideals were also deeply rooted in familial, cultural, and historical contexts.

Despite the prominence of love in OPM, there remained limited scholarly research examining Filipino music through the lens of philosophical frameworks of love, particularly the Ancient Greek forms. This gap is significant, as music played a crucial role in shaping emotional understanding and relational expectations among young listeners. Chen (2023) emphasized that music influenced adolescent mental health by promoting emotional expression and regulation, which fosters social connections, having a sense of belonging, promoting creativity, and cognitive development. Such

findings underscored the importance of exploring how music conveys complex emotional and relational experiences.

Considering that young listeners often turned to music for guidance, comfort, and social learning, analyzing lyrical content provides valuable insights into both individual and collective experiences of love.

This research examined how Cup of Joe's lyrics portrayed different types of love through the Ancient Greek concepts of eros, philia, storge, and agape, highlighted themes of romantic passion, friendship, familial affection, and selfless devotion. It also explored the tension between idealized romance and real-life relationships, aiming to encourage a more critical understanding of how Filipino popular music reflected and shaped young listeners' emotional and moral perspectives.

Literature Review

Love has been a central focus of inquiry in philosophy, art, and music, encompassing diverse forms. A literature review is critical for contextualizing the study, identifying gaps in existing research, and establishing a foundation for analyzing contemporary musical representations of love.

Musical Expressions

According to Bamford, Vigl, Hämäläinen, and Saarikallio (2024) highlighted music frequently conveys themes of love and romantic connection, with love-themed lyrics appearing across cultures and suggested that music played an integral role in expressing and reinforcing emotional and relational aspects of romantic relationships. Music allowed the listeners to interpret songs and connect them to personal experiences that enabled the listeners to do meaningful reflection that shapes their values and how they perceive relationships. Meyer (1956) emotional meaning in music arises from manipulation of musical expectations, through patterns

of tension and resolution. In the context of lyrical music, these structural features interacted with semantic content to enhance emotional impact, suggesting that both musical composition and lyrical expression work together to shape listeners' perceptions of romantic and relational themes. Moreover, Putkinen et al. (2020) emphasized the idea that music can fuel strong subjective emotions though it remained a debate on whether responses have the same neural circuits as emotions triggered by biologically significant events.

Idealization of Love

Martín-Salvador et al. (2021) highlighted that idealization of love and romance among young people are a prevalent cultural phenomenon, which leads to dysfunctional relationships. Hence, this idealization shaped how young people perceive and approach relationships, reinforcing standards that are difficult to meet and increasing the likelihood of relational challenges. Their study of Spanish adolescents found that adherence to myths about love—such as jealousy being a sign of affection, the omnipotence of love, and the necessity of exclusivity or marriage—was associated with a lower perception of the severity of abusive behaviors, with notable differences between genders. Specifically, myths emphasized possession and dedication influenced males' perceptions, whereas beliefs in the omnipotence of love affected females' perceptions. These findings suggested that such cultural beliefs not only shape adolescents' understanding of healthy and abusive relationship behaviors but also reinforce gendered expectations in romantic contexts. Moreover, Ruiz-Palomino et al. (2021), romantic experiences during adolescence influence later relational functioning, and adherence to myths about romantic love has been linked to lower perceptions of the severity of abusive behaviors, with gender moderating these effects.

Original Pinoy Music and Representation of Love

Original Pinoy Music (OPM) has played a significant role in Filipino cultural expression, specifically in the portrayals of emotions, romance, and intrapersonal relationships. Related literature shows that popular songs often employed linguistic and semantic choices

that resonated with listeners and carried reflective and emotional meaning. In a study conducted by Lano et al. (n.d.), OPM songs preferred by the Filipino youth were found to contain recurring types of meaning—such as affection, interpersonal connection, and emotional experience—which were evident in the top-selected songs. These findings aligned with the predominance of pop and indie genres among young listeners.

While much studies focused on meanings and preferences of the youth, the use of content analysis in examining structural features in OPM emphasized how synthetic patterns contributed to the emotional impact and music accessibility. In a qualitative study utilizing three trending songs from Spotify 2023, *Leaves* by Ben & Ben (2017) *Happy W U* by Arthur Nery (2020) and *I Want You* by SB19 (2023) conducted by Sumbad (2025), found that simple compound, and imperative sentence structures were dominant in such OPM lyrics, with common use of informal language, repetition, and deviations such as double negatives. These syntactic features not only reflect casual, interpersonal communication but also reinforced the emotional emphasis and meaning within the songs.

These findings highlighted the significance of OPM as both a reflection and a shaper of young people's perceptions of romantic love. In the case of Cup of Joe, analyzing their lyrics similarly showed how the band communicated ideals of love, emotional experiences, and relationship expectations to their audience. By studying the lyrics systematically, researchers were able to trace how these musical portrayals both reflected Filipino cultural values and shaped young listeners' understanding of romantic relationships, emotional expression, and interpersonal connections. This underscored the importance of OPM, including Cup of Joe's songs, as a cultural artifact that influenced attitudes, emotions, and relational behaviors among Filipino youth.

Content Analysis in Music

Content analysis had been widely used as a methodological approach in examining texts, particularly in language, literature, and media studies. Several scholars emphasized that content analysis allowed researchers to systematically identify patterns, themes, and meanings embedded in textual data. Studies published in linguistic and literary journals explained that this method is effective in uncovering both explicit and implicit messages in texts, as it combined systematic categorization with interpretive analysis. Through content analysis, researchers were able to connect language use with cultural, social, and emotional contexts.

In a research study published by Yusnitasari et al. (2022) which analyzed figurative language in the song *“You Are My Sunshine”* By Anne Murray (1987), the findings demonstrated how lyrics contained metaphor, symbolism, and imagery that conveyed deeper emotional messages beyond literal words. This indicated that qualitative analysis of lyrics could uncover nuanced linguistic elements. Another study published by Amri and Djuharie (2025) revealed how word choice and semantic fields in the lyrics constructed interconnected themes of memory, love, and emotional pain, demonstrating how even limited lyrical language could express intense feelings.

Similarly, a study by Evelyn (2025), which analyzed the song *“Understand”* By Keshi (2022) using content analysis, revealed how representations of love in the lyrics communicate intimacy, passion, and emotional connection, highlighted that song lyrics serve as meaningful mediums for emotional reflection.

Furthermore, content analysis was also used to examine the cultural themes presented in songs. Research conducted by Antolin et al. (2025) which focused on Filipino music—specifically songs by SB19 found that lyrics communicated not only by personal emotions, but also the cultural values portrayed in the songs, fostering both

emotional and societal perspectives in song interpretation. Additionally, a study by Rizka (2024) which analyzed figurative language in *Lover* by Taylor Swift's, found that lyricism constructed meaning through literary devices. This reinforced the idea that song lyrics could be studied like literary texts to understand narrative and emotional content.

However, no research had been conducted using Cup of Joe as the subject of the study that utilized content analysis. This study aimed to fill this gap by analyzing selected song lyrics of Cup of Joe to identify common themes, language patterns, and expressions of love. By focusing on a contemporary Filipino band, the study sought to contribute to existing research on song lyric analysis and to explain how love is portrayed in Original Pilipino Music (OPM).

Greek Concept of Love

Greek philosophy introduced the different forms of love that helped explain how love was understood and expressed in various ways. Love is expressed in several forms, namely: *eros*, *philia*, *ludus*, *mania*, *pragma*, and *agape*. Each of these represented a distinct type of love. These concepts of love were not limited to romance; they are also applicable to friendship, moral responsibility, practicality, and selfless care for other people (Thompson, 2024).

Eros are often described as romantic or passionate love. According to classical and contemporary philosophical discussions, eros involved attraction, emotional intensity and desire. While it could be associated with physical or romantic longing, (Youvan, 2024) emphasized that eros also represented a deep emotional connection that motivated individuals toward intimacy and personal fulfillment. However, Beattie (2025) noted that eros are powerful, because it involves attraction and that required balance as unchecked desire can lead to emotional conflict.

In contrast, *philia* referred to love rooted in friendships, loyalty, and mutual respect. Philosophers described *philia* as a bond that developed through trust, understanding, and shared experiences. In a paper published by Youvan (2024), it was highlighted that this form of love is stable and enduring because it was based on equality and emotional support rather than passion alone. *Philia* is often visible in friendships, family relationships, and communities where emotional connection grew over time (CEEOL, 2024).

Ludus are a form of love in Greek and it is characterized as playful, flirtation, and a lighthearted approach to romantic relationships, where emotional depth and commitment were often put secondary to enjoyment and excitement. Gurtapa (2025) emphasized that *ludus* was more about spontaneity and the thrill of unexpected encounters and exciting experiences, rather than deep emotional investment in another person. Moreover, *ludus* was typically not exclusive, as individuals involved could be open to multiple partners.

Mania, as described by Linter (2024) was an intense and obsessive form of love that often manifested in possessiveness and erratic behavior. She further emphasized that modern psychology viewed *mania* as unhealthy, as it caused individuals to become dependent on their partner, often driven by fear, insecurity, and possessiveness. *Mania* could also be linked to insecure attachment style, and traumatic love experiences.

Pragma are a form of love that leaned more into practicality. According to Burton (2024), *pragma* was founded on reason and long-term interest. It emphasized compatibility, shared goals, and mutual benefit rather than intense passion or impulsive emotion. This type of love often developed slowly over time, growing out of commitment, trust, and consistent effort. Individuals who value *pragma* tend to consider factors such as stability, life plans, family values, and personal ambitions when choosing a partner. Rather than being driven primarily by chemistry or romantic idealism, *pragma* focused on building a relationship that is sustainable and

resilient. It was commonly observed in long-lasting marriages and partnerships where both individuals prioritized cooperation, compromise, and long-term fulfillment.

The final concept, agape, was defined by philosophers as selfless and unconditional love. Agape emphasized caring for others without expecting anything in return. (Thompson, 2024) stated that agape is associated with sacrifice, compassion, and moral responsibility. It was also closely associated with Christianity, where it described a form of love that prioritized the well-being of others and reflected deep emotional and ethical commitment (Youvan, 2024).

Recent studies still continued to apply these Greek concepts to modern contexts, including literature, social movements, and cultural analysis. Existing studies suggested that eros, philia, and agape remained useful frameworks for interpreting emotional expression in texts, as they allowed scholars to distinguish different types of love based on intention, emotion, and relationship dynamics (SAGE Journals, 2025; Brill, 2024). These concepts were especially valuable in analyzing song lyrics, where love is often expressed in varied and overlapping forms.

Music and Cultural Identity

Music has long been viewed as a universal language that significantly impacts our society. OPM songs have been a way for Filipinos to convey emotions, showcase culture, and communicate. Nevertheless, with the passage of time, the feelings and cultural themes found in OPM songs have also transformed (Sebio, 2023).

Ramos (2025) emphasized how the indigenous concept of "*loob*" (inner being) shaped Filipino understandings of love, as love was viewed as a conscious choice made by an individual. Moreover, Tabuena (2022) discussed how the arts, particularly music, functioned as a source of optimism and collective strength during catastrophe such as the pandemic and natural disasters.

Espiritu et al., (2025) highlighted music that helps visualize everyday life and tell meaningful stories, allowing people to see their own experiences, values, and struggles reflected in songs. It also helped individuals understand the country better by expressing Filipino identity, and helping the preservation of traditional Filipino cultures and values.

No research had yet been conducted using Cup of Joe as the corpus of a study that applied content analysis to examine expressions of love in their song lyrics. While existing studies had explored Greek concepts of love such as *eros*, *ludus*, *mania*, *philia*, *pragma*, and *agape* (Thompson, 2024; Youvan, 2024), Burton (2024) further contributes to this body of literature by situating these forms of love within a broader psychological framework and analyzed lyrics of international artists (Amri & Djuharie, 2025; Evelyn, 2025). However, there is a clear gap in research on Original Pilipino Music (OPM), particularly contemporary bands such as Cup of Joe.

This study aimed to address these gaps by systematically analyzing selected songs of Cup of Joe using content analysis. Specifically, it sought to identify recurring themes, linguistic patterns, and representations of love, and to classify them according to Greek concepts of love. By doing so, the research provided insights into how love is portrayed in OPM and contributed to a deeper perception of the emotional and cultural depth reflected on contemporary Filipino music. This approach also allowed scholars to explore how musical and lyrical expression may shape listeners' perceptions of love, relationships, and interpersonal connection in a Filipino context.

Theoretical Framework

In order to comprehend how love was depicted in the chosen songs of Cup of Joe, Multo (2024), Tingin (2023), Estranghero (2022), Misteryoso (2024), Ikaw Pa Rin Ang Pipiliin Ko (2021), Patutunguhan (2023), Pahina (2025), Mananatili (2022), Nag-lisang Muli (2019), Sagada (2020), three related theories were

used in this study, titled "*Cup of Love: An Analysis of How Love is Portrayed on the Songs of Cup of Joe*." These theories helped explain how song lyrics conveyed, experienced, and interpreted love.

First, formalism, as applied by Cleanth Brooks, was used to examine the internal features of song lyrics, including imagery, symbolism, repetition, tone, diction, and metaphorical language. Formalism emphasized that meaning can be extracted from the text itself, independent of external context. Through this theoretical lens, the study investigated how specific linguistic and poetic elements conveyed love in songs and how recurring motifs and patterns helped construct overarching themes. This approach was critical to the study, as it enabled a detailed thematic analysis of the lyrics and facilitated the identification of how different forms of love were represented and how central themes emerge from the text's formal elements.

Second, Love Styles Theory by John Alan Lee were used to identify the forms of love portrayed in the songs of Cup of Joe. According to Lee (1973), love could manifest in different forms such as passionate love, selfless love, practical love, playful love, and emotional or friendship love. Rather than viewing love as a single universal feeling, the theory emphasized that individuals experienced and expressed affection based on distinct attitudes and motivations. This perspective allowed a deeper understanding of how emotions were shaped by personal values, expectations, and relational goals.

In analyzing songs, Lee's framework proved especially useful because music often mirrors real emotional patterns in relationships. It helped identify the dominant love style expressed in each piece. By applying this theory, the songs were understood not merely as narratives of love but as representations of diverse ways individuals experienced and sustained love in real life.

Finally, Cultural Theory by Lev Vygotsky was used to examine how the songs reflected, reinforced, or challenged Filipino values and ideologies about love. This theory considered how cultural norms, traditions, and social expectations shaped representations of love in artistic works, specifically in music. Through cultural analysis, themes such as loyalty (*katapatan*), sacrifice (*pagsasakripisyo*), emotional restraint, and romantic idealism are explored. It explained how Cup of Joe's songs resonated with or questioned Filipino perspectives on love and relationships.

Together, these theories provided a comprehensive framework for analyzing the linguistic elements, forms of love, and cultural meanings embedded in the songs of Cup of Joe. The integration of love styles theory, formalism, and cultural theory allowed the study to examine how music reflected personal emotions and societal values, particularly those experienced by Filipino youth.

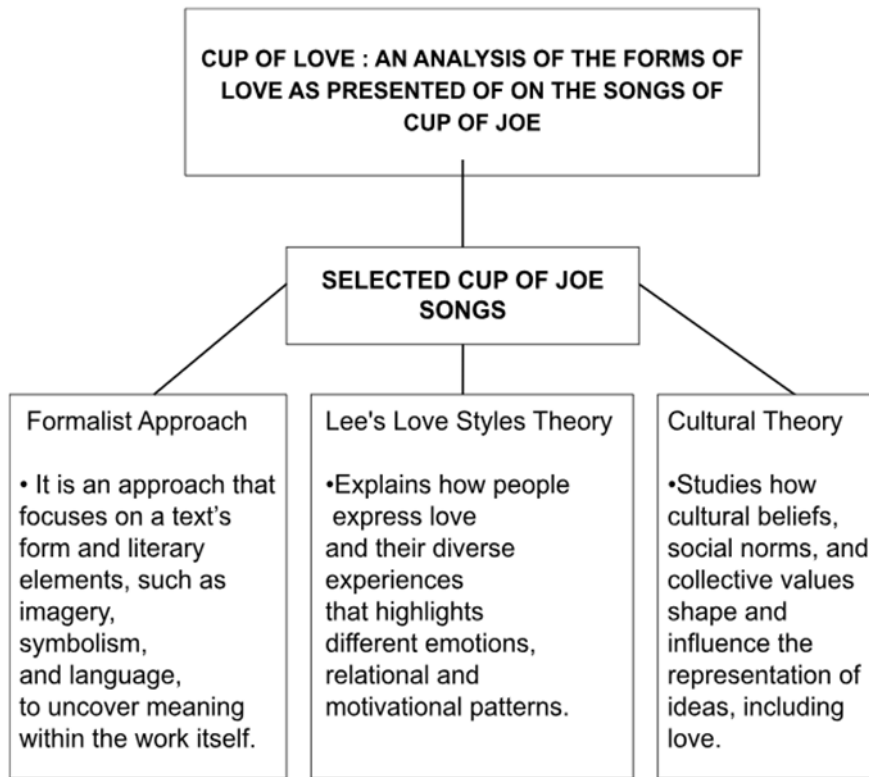


Figure 1. Theoretical Framework

Statement of the Problem

Although love had been a common theme in contemporary music, there had been limited research analyzing how bands portrayed different forms of love in their lyrics. This study sought to examine how the selected songs of Cup of Joe expressed and represented these various forms of love.

Specifically, it answered the following questions:

1. What forms of love were expressed in the selected Cup of Joe songs based on the lyrical analysis?
2. What themes were present in the songs' lyrics that illustrated the concept of love?
3. How did the selected Cup of Joe songs reflect or challenge Filipino values and ideologies about love?

Scope and Delimitation

This study focused on the lyrics of selected officially released and most-streamed songs by the Filipino band Cup of Joe that explicitly or implicitly addressed the theme of love. Love is examined through portrayals of devotion, vulnerability, longing, affection, and self-reflection. The songs were treated as literary texts and are analyzed to reveal their emotional depth and the cultural perspectives embedded in their lyrics.

The scope of the study is limited to the ten most-streamed officially released songs by Filipino listeners that are clearly engaged with the theme of love, based on recurring motifs, language, and emotional orientation in the lyrics. Unreleased tracks, live performances, cover versions, and music videos are excluded. The study did not examine musical composition, instrumentation, vocal performance, audience reception, commercial success, or biographical interpretations of the band members' personal lives.

The analysis centered solely on the lyrical content of the songs as retrieved on January 24, 2026.

Furthermore, this research was qualitative in nature and relied on close reading and textual analysis guided by relevant literary theories, such as narrative and thematic analysis. The interpretations presented in the study were shaped by the researcher's critical perspective and did not claim to represent definitive or universal meanings of the songs. As such, the findings aimed to contribute to academic discussions on contemporary Filipino music and lyrical representations of love rather than to generalize across all musical genres or performers.

Significance of the Study

This study explored the different forms of love and how they were depicted in Cup of Joe's song lyrics. It aimed to provide a better understanding of how Cup of Joe's songs created, expressed, and conveyed various forms of love. The findings of this research were expected to be particularly beneficial for the following:

Music Industry. Artists, songwriters, producers, and other stakeholders in the music industry may benefit from understanding how different forms of love are presented in song lyrics. This knowledge can guide the creation of meaningful and relatable songs that reflect the emotions and experiences of Filipino listeners.

Filipino Culture and OPM Studies. This study also contributes to the appreciation and preservation of Original Pilipino Music (OPM) by showing how contemporary Filipino songs reflect cultural values, emotional expression, and shared social experiences. It highlights how love and relationships are shaped by Filipino values, promotes awareness and appreciation of OPM, and reinforces music as a medium for expressing Filipino identity and collective experiences.

Listeners of Cup of Joe. Listeners may gain a deeper understanding of how love is expressed in Cup of Joe's songs. The study may encourage personal reflection and help listeners connect the themes of love in the music to their own life experiences.

Teachers. This study can be beneficial to teachers who use contemporary Filipino songs as learning materials in subjects such as literature, music, and social studies. Analyzing the different forms of love found in the songs can promote classroom discussions, critical thinking, and appreciation of OPM and Filipino culture.

Students. Students would be able to develop a better perception of the different forms of love as well as how they are conveyed through song lyrics. The study can improve their skills in analyzing lyrics as literary texts and make learning more engaging by relating lessons to music they are familiar with.

Researchers. This study can contribute to research on music and lyrics by showing how words, themes, and emotions are used to express love. It can help researchers better understand how Filipino songs reflect emotions and experiences related to love and relationships. Moreover, the study can contribute to academic discussions and gain understanding how music shapes our perception in different forms of love.

Future Researchers. This study serves as reference for future researchers who desire to conduct similar studies on lyrics, love themes, or Filipino music. It also encourages further research on other OPM artists, musical genres, or deeper explorations of love using different research approaches.

Chapter II

METHODS

Research Design

This study employed content analysis, a qualitative research approach, to address the questions surrounding *Cup of Joe's* songs. It was conducted through a systematic analysis of the lyrics of each selected song. Hence, no participants were involved and no interviews were conducted. Content analysis was employed because it allowed the researchers to systematically examine and interpret data in an organized and systematic manner.

An article entitled “*Content Analysis Method and Examples*” from *Columbia Public Health* (2023) states content analysis is a research tool used to determine the presence of certain words, themes, or concepts within some given qualitative data (i.e. text). Through this method, the researchers categorized the data to identify the recurring themes, the form of love being portrayed in each song, and the representation of Filipino values, specifically in romance. Furthermore, this method was appropriate for the study as it provided a reliable means of exploring artistic expression in music while maintaining objectivity.

Through this approach, the researchers gained a deeper understanding of how love was portrayed in the band's songs and how these portrayals reflected broader emotional and cultural themes.

Selection of Corpora

The corpus of this study consisted of songs by the Filipino band **Cup of Joe**, which were analyzed to identify and examine the different forms of love portrayed in their music. The research focused on the lyrical content of selected songs, exploring how love is expressed through themes such as romantic love, self-love, familial love, and emotional growth.

This study treated the songs as literary and cultural texts, analyzing their meanings, messages, and emotional representations rather than the personal lives of the band members. The analysis remained centered on how the lyrics convey distinct forms of love that resonated with the listeners, particularly the youth. The following inclusions and criteria are as it follows:

1. The song was officially released by Cup of Joe.
2. The song prominently featured themes of love, relationships, or emotional experiences.
3. The song was included in the band's top ten most-streamed tracks on Spotify to ensure cultural relevance and resonance with contemporary audiences.
4. Lyrics were accessible through verified sources, such as Spotify and the website Genius, to ensure accuracy.

By analyzing the selected songs, the study aimed to contribute a more comprehensive interpretation of contemporary Filipino music that portrayed different forms of love as well as contributed to both the emotional and cultural experiences of its audience.

Research Instrument

This study utilized coding sheets as the primary qualitative research instrument to address the research questions related to the

songs of *Cup of Joe*. The study focused on the systematic examination of song lyrics, which was carried out as the primary source of data. Since this research relied solely on textual materials, no participants were involved and no interviews were conducted.

Coding sheets were used to organize, classify, and interpret recurring words, themes, and concepts found in the lyrics. Through these coding sheets, the researchers identified patterns and meanings relevant to the thematic focus of the songs. This approach confirmed a structured and consistent analysis of the lyrical content.

Data Gathering Procedure

To systematically collect the necessary information, the following procedures were employed:

The data consisted of the official lyrics of the top ten most listened-to songs from the band *Cup of Joe* based on the popularity among Filipino listeners. The selected songs were intentionally chosen for their relevance to themes of love and relationships, as well as their popularity and cultural impact among Filipino music listeners. The lyrics were gathered from verified sources, compiled into a single document, and relevant excerpts were then analyzed in relation to the study's theoretical frameworks on the different forms of love.

Data Analysis

The data were analyzed by examining significant lines from the lyrics of selected songs officially released by the band *Cup of Joe*, chosen for their focus on love and relationships. Coding sheets are used to systematically write down song lyrics, phrases, imagery, and emotional expressions related to love, which were identified through repeated readings of the lyrics and grouped into recurring themes. These themes were then classified using Lee's Love Styles Theory (1973) particularly *Eros* (romantic love), *Philia* (friendship-based love), *Ludus* (playful Love), *Mania* (obsessive love) *Pragma* (practical love) and *Agape* (selfless love). Finally, Cultural Theory was applied

to interpret how these representations of love reflect Filipino cultural values, social norms, and shared emotional experiences.

Ethical Considerations

This study adhered to ethical rules in research in accordance with Republic Act No. 8293 (Intellectual Property Code of the Philippines), as amended by Republic Act No. 10372, ensuring that all intellectual works used are properly credited. Publicly available materials, such as officially released song lyrics of *Cup of Joe*, are used for academic purposes only, with accurate citations and adherence to fair use principles. The researchers ensured ethical conduct by avoiding plagiarism through proper paraphrasing and clear identification of direct quotations.

Prior to publication, the artist or band were notified regarding the use of their works to prevent misinterpretation or misuse. The study also respected cultural and societal values reflected in the lyrics, avoiding misrepresentation of the artist's intended message. Since no participants were involved, ethical concerns related to privacy or consent do not apply. By adhering to these ethical standards, the study promoted honesty, accountability, and respect for creative and scholarly contributions, while fully aligning with Philippine intellectual property laws and accepted academic research practices.

Chapter III

RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS

Presentation of Key Findings

The youth used music in ways to convey their feelings, emotions, and how they perceive the world around the environment. (Hanzilia et al., 2024). After analyzing in meticulous detail, the songs of *Cup of Joe*, how love was portrayed, and the themes presented, the researchers came up with the following findings, pertinent to the research: (1) Forms of Love Expressed in the selected COJ Songs, (2) Themes present in the songs lyrics and (3) Cup of Joe's Cultural Resonance.

Forms of Love Expressed in the selected COJ Songs

The researchers used Lee's Love Styles Theory as the primary theoretical framework which addressed research question one. The examination of the chosen songs by Cup of Joe indicated that the love themes in the lyrics showcased various love styles.

By analyzing the lyrical components, consistent themes of nostalgia, loyalty, and yearning were discovered, illustrating how love was depicted in diverse manners that include both emotional depth and relationship growth. Table One (1) showcased the recognized love styles, the associated songs, and key lyrical excerpts that reinforce the interpretations. Lee's Love Styles Theory (1973) categorized love into six distinct types: Eros (romantic affection), Philia (companionship love), Ludus (playful affection), Mania (obsessive attachment), Pragma (pragmatic love), and Agape (selfless affection).

Table 1. Forms of Love Expressed In the Selected COJ songs

Form of Love	Lyrical Evidence	Formalistic Element	Interpretation
Eros	<i>“Di pinapansin, ingay sa tabi, magulong kapaligiran, sa’yo lang ang tingin”</i> (Tingin, 2023) (Ignoring noise nearby, chaotic surroundings, only looking at you) <i>“Ano mang takbo ng panahon, kahit na ako’y biglang matangay, wala mang himlay, basta ako’y patungo sa’yo”</i> (Patutunguhan, 2023) (No matter how time passes, even if I’m suddenly swept away, there’s no rest, as long as I’m heading towards you)	Imagery, Contrast and Hyperbole	The chaotic surroundings emphasized that the speaker’s attention was solely on the beloved, showing intense romantic focus. It conveyed passionate longing and determination to be with the beloved despite obstacles, reflecting deep romantic desire.

Agape	<i>“Mananatili, hindi tiyak ang bukas natin, ngunit itong gabi ay atin”</i> (Mananatili, 2022) (Stay, tomorrow is uncertain, but this night is ours) <i>“Iyong tandaan na ako’y masayang ika’y malaya na”</i> (Sagada, 2020) (Remember that I am happy you are free)	Tone, Imagery, and Emotive Diction	It reflected love that was freely given in the present moment, valuing devotion without expectation. The lyrics demonstrated sacrificial love, prioritizing the beloved’s well-being over personal feelings.
Mania	<i>“Minumulto na ‘ko ng damdamin ko”</i> (Multo, 2024) (My feelings are haunting me) <i>“Sa lahat ng pahinang sinulat ng tadhana’y ikaw at ikaw pa rin”</i> (Pahina, 2025) (In all the pages written by fate, it’s you, and you, and always you)	Hyperbole, Imagery, and Repetition	It showed obsessive and emotionally unstable love, reflecting deep attachment and an inability to let go. The overwhelming longing showed the intense and dependent nature of Mania. The singer showed intense fixation, emotional overwhelm, and fear of losing the beloved.

The table provided a broader formal analysis of how different forms of love - the Eros, Agape and Mania - are expressed in the selected songs of the Cup of Joe (COJ) by closely examining the structure, vocabulary and imagery of the lyrics themselves. In the case of Eros, the line "*Di pinapansin, ingay sa tabi, magulong kapaligiran, sa'yo lang ang tingin*" (Ignoring noise nearby, chaotic surroundings, only looking at you) in the song Tingin (2023) used contrast as a key literary tool, deliberately describing noisy and chaotic environments to emphasize the way in which the audience's attention is restricted to one person. This selective focus suggested that romantic love dominated perception and disappeared into the background. The repetition of external distractions against a single attention exacerbates the idea that Eros is not only attractive, but a profound emotional experience that focuses completely on the person you love.

For Agape, the lyrics "*Iyong tandaan na ako'y masayang ika'y malaya na*" (Remember that I am happy you are free) in Sagada (2020) changed the tone into something more subdued and reflective and highlighted selflessness through language. The phrase itself has emotional restrictions because it does not express bitterness or jealousy, but rather chooses acceptance and genuine happiness for the freedom of others. From a formalist point of view, the simplicity and sincerity of these words reinforced the purity of the love of Agape. The structure of the sentences, especially the emphasis on "*Masayang*" (happy) and "*Malay*" (free), showed that the well-being of the other person is consciously given priority over personal belonging. This showed that love transcends desire in this way and becomes an act of unconditional care.

On the contrary, Mania was represented in more intense and almost disturbing images in the line "*Minumulto na'ko ng Damdamin ko*" (My feelings are haunting me) in Multo (2024) because of the metaphor being "haunted" by the feelings of oneself implied a loss of control where emotions were no longer comforting, but intrusive and persistent. The use of the word "minumulto" (haunted) created a vivid image of something that cannot be escaped, implying that the speaker was trapped in his emotional state. The song also

highlighted the overwhelming darkness caused by obsessive love. Through these choices of words and images, the text effectively conveyed that Mania is characterized by intensity, which is near distress, where love is consumed rather than nurtured.

Overall, the table showed by applying formalist methods, meaning it is not derived from external contexts, but from internal elements of the text—meaning, images, and structure. Each type of love was clearly expressed through specific linguistic choices: Eros through contrast and concentrated attention, Agape through simplicity and selfless expression, and Mania through captivating metaphors and emotional intensity. This shows how literary techniques in the lyrics of songs could powerfully capture the complexity of human emotions, and the analysis of language alone allowed understanding the various forms of love.

Themes present in the songs lyrics

Formalism by Cleanth Brooks was used to answer the second research question by studying the recurring themes of selected songs. A detailed analysis of lyrical elements, such as structure, language, and literary tools, revealed patterns of emotion and thought expression in songs. With this approach, researchers focused on the internal elements of the text, rather than external factors, allowing them to understand more clearly how the meaning is constructed through the words. Analysis showed that songs often depict memories, devotions, and desires that highlighted the various dimensions of love and the emotional depth of lovers' relationships. These repeated themes showed how songs expressed personal feelings, memories and lasting relationships, reflecting the complex love experiences expressed in lyrical compositions.

Table 2. Themes present in the songs lyrics

Themes of Love	Lyrical Evidence	Interpretation
Sentimental Reflection	<i>“Ako’y nag-iisang muli hawak ang alaala mo”</i> (I am alone again holding your memory) (Ikaw Pa Rin Ang Pipiliin Ko, 2021) <i>“Bawat buklat ng aklat, binabalikan”</i> (Every page of the book, revisited) (Pahina, 2025)	The emotions were centered on remembering moments of being in love, showing a sentimental attachment to the past and falling into the theme of sentimental reflection.
Steadfast Affection	<i>“Kahit ika’y mapalayo sa piling ko, ikaw pa rin ang pipiliin ko”</i> (Even if you are far from me, I will still choose you) (Ikaw Pa Rin Ang Pipiliin Ko, 2021) <i>“Mahal, ikaw lang, ang nakikita ng bulag kong paningin”</i> (Love, only you, my blind eyes see only you) (Patutunguhan, 2023)	It emphasized loyalty to remain even during times of hardship, highlighting steadfast commitment and affection toward the beloved.

Lingering Presence	“Nais na maramdaman muli, kung pa’no isulat ang pangalan mo” (“I long to feel again what it is like to write your name.” (Pahina, 2025) <i>“Kasama ka ngunit ba’t nangungulila pa rin?”</i> (“You are with me, yet why do I still feel lonely?”) (Estranghero, 2022)	These lines expressed how the speaker continued to think about the person repeatedly and could not move on, which showed longing. The singer longed to feel once again the presence of the beloved.
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Analysis of the selected songs highlighted recurring themes of love, specifically unwavering devotion, nostalgic reminiscing, and enduring presence. A close examination of the lyrics revealed love as a multifaceted emotional journey encompassing loyalty, sentimentality, and yearning. The lyrical language, imagery, and repetition showcased how romantic bonds are recalled, cherished, and longed for, even amidst separation or doubt. These recurring patterns suggested that love was communicated not only through overt expressions of affection but also through cherished memories and profound emotional desires for the beloved. The consistent presence of these themes across various songs underscored love's enduring power, irrespective of shifting circumstances.

The initial theme identified was steadfast affection, embodying loyalty, fidelity, and a deep commitment to a loved one. This is apparent in multiple songs where the speaker affirmed an unwavering dedication to an individual, even when faced with obstacles. For instance, in the song "Tingin," (2023) the lyric *“Sa’yo lang magpapaangkin, ’di palalampasin”* (“I will claim only you, I will not miss it”) exemplified this exclusive devotion.

Similarly, the song *Patutunguhan* (2023) illustrated unwavering devotion with the line, "*Mahal, ikaw lang ang nakikita ng bulag kong paningin, ikaw lang ang ilaw sa dilim*" ("Love, only you my blind eyes see, the light in the darkness"). The metaphor "*bulag kong paningin*" (My blind eyes) suggested that even when the speaker feels lost or unsure, their focus remained fixed on the same person. This imagery underscored constancy in love, demonstrating that emotional commitment endures even when situations become uncertain. The beloved was also portrayed as "the light in the darkness," representing guidance and emotional support. This metaphor highlighted how love offers clarity and purpose, especially during times of confusion.

A powerful illustration of enduring love was in "*Ikaw Pa Rin Ang Pipiliin Ko*," (2021) particularly in the line, "*Kahit ika'y mapalayo sa piling ko, ikaw pa rin ang pipiliin ko*" ("Even if you are far from me, I will still choose you"). The repeated use of "*kahit*" (even if) suggested potential hurdles such as distance, time, or unforeseen circumstances that might test a relationship. Despite these obstacles, the speaker unequivocally affirmed their continued choice of the same person. This underscored that love required perseverance and loyalty, especially when a relationship encounters difficulties.

Similarly, the song "*Pahina*" (2025) also exemplified steadfast affection through the lyric, "*Sa lahat ng pahinang sinulat ng tadhana'y, ikaw at ikaw at ikaw pa rin*" ("In all the pages written by fate, you and you and still you"). The repetition of "*ikaw*" (you) amplified the idea that the beloved remained the sole occupant of the speaker's heart. This linguistic emphasis on a single individual highlighted a profound and consistent devotion.

The second theme that emerged from the analysis was sentimental reflection, which focused on nostalgia and the recollection of shared past experiences with a loved one. Many of the songs depicted love as a force that persisted through memories, even after a separation.

From a formalist perspective, the repetition employed engendered a sensation of emotional confinement, wherein the speaker finds it difficult to escape persistent memories that continued to haunt them. This mechanism underscored the theme of nostalgia by illustrating the enduring presence of the past within the speaker's emotional experience.

A comparable notion was expressed in the song "Estranghero", where in the lyric "*Hinahanap-hanap, tamis ng nakaraan, ba't tinatalikuran?*" ("Are you longing for the sweetness of the past, but are you abandoning it?") encapsulated the ambivalent nature of nostalgia. The speaker reflected the bittersweet quality of past memories while simultaneously questioning the reasons for their abandonment. This duality evoked a sense of emotional tension, as the past is fondly recalled yet remains irretrievable.

Nostalgic sentiment was further evident in "Ikaw Pa Rin Ang Pipiliin Ko" through the line "*Ako'y nag-iisang muli hawak ang alaala mo*" ("I am alone again holding your memory"). The speaker conveyed solitude while maintaining an attachment to the beloved's memory, with the metaphor of "holding" suggesting that the past relationship continued to influence the speaker's emotional state.

Similarly, the song "Pahina" employed the metaphor "*Bawat buklat ng aklat, binabalikan*" ("Every page of the book, revisited") to evoke reflective sentimentality. In this lyric, memories were likened to pages within a book, symbolizing experiences that can be revisited and recalled. Each "page" signified a shared moment between lovers, and the act of revisiting these pages reflects a desire to relive significant memories. Conversely, the song "Sagada" conveyed a more hopeful dimension of nostalgia through the line "*Sa langit na ikaw ay muling matanaw*" ("In heaven you will be seen again"). This lyric intimated that the speaker continued to cherish the memory of the beloved while nurturing the hope of a future reunion. Collectively, these examples demonstrated how sentimental reflection revealed the enduring emotional significance of memories of love, persisting long after the relationship has transformed or concluded.

The third recurring theme in these selected songs was the enduring presence, which centered on yearning and the emotional challenge of letting go of someone who once played a significant role in one's life. In the song "Tingin," the line "*Sa'yo lang magpapaangkin, 'di palalampasin, wag ka sanang kumawala*" ("I will let myself belong only to you; I won't let this pass—please don't slip away") revealed a deep emotional attachment. The speaker showed vulnerability and fear of losing the relationship, highlighting a strong desire for the loved one to remain. This wish to hold on demonstrated how love could create a powerful emotional bond that is hard to break.

Yearning was also evident in the song "Estranghero," (2022) especially in the line "*Kasama ka ngunit ba't nangungulila pa rin?*" ("You are with me, yet why do I still feel lonely?"). Despite physical presence, the speaker sensed emotion expressing a longing for a deeper connection that no longer existed. Likewise, "Ikaw Pa Rin Ang Pipiliin Ko" conveyed longing through its affirmation of continued devotion despite separation, reflecting hope that the relationship would endure. The theme of lingering presence is powerfully conveyed in "Pahina" (2025) with the line "*Nais na maramdaman muli, kung pa'no isulat ang pangalan mo*" ("I long to feel again what it is like to write your name"). This suggested that the beloved remained vividly present in the speaker's mind. Writing the name symbolized intimacy and emotional closeness, and the desire to experience it again underscored the speaker's yearning for the past relationship. In "Nag-iisang Muli," (2019) the line "*Ang tanging hangad ng puso'y ikaw*" ("You are the heart's only longing") expressed the depth of the speaker's desire. The beloved was depicted as the sole object of the heart's true longing, emphasizing the intensity of the emotional connection.

Other songs also explored this theme through metaphors of yearning and pursuit. In "Misteryoso," (2024) the lyric "*Nais masilayan ang iyong mga matang, puno ng lihim at ng kislap*" ("It longs to gaze upon your eyes, filled with secrets and sparkling light") conveyed a strong desire to be close to the beloved. The speaker's longing to look into the other's eyes symbolized a deeper wish to

understand and form a meaningful connection. Meanwhile, "Patutunguhan" expresses longing through the metaphor "*Ako'y sumasalungat na sa alon, nakatuon sa 'yong direksyon*" ("I am going against the waves, focused on your direction"). This imagery suggested the speaker is willing to face difficulties and obstacles as their desire to reach the beloved surpassed all else.

Collectively, the themes of steadfast affection, sentimental reflection, and lingering presence revealed how the selected songs portrayed love as an enduring and emotionally complex experience. Steadfast affection emphasized loyalty and commitment, showing that love can remain strong even through distance or hardship. Sentimental reflection highlighted the importance of memories and nostalgia, demonstrating how past relationships continue to influence a person's emotions. Meanwhile, lingering presence captured the feeling of longing, where the beloved remains deeply embedded in the speaker's thoughts and desires. Through these recurrent motifs, the songs collectively demonstrated how love endured through memory, fidelity, and yearning, thereby highlighting the profound emotional complexity inherent in their lyrical narratives.

Cup of Joe's Cultural Resonance

Using Cultural Theory as the primary theoretical lens to address research question three, the songs of Cup of Joe illustrated how Filipinos experienced love while simultaneously idealizing it according to cultural values, social norms, and collective expectations. Cultural Theory posited that individual emotions and behaviors are shaped not only by personal inclinations but also by shared meanings, traditions, and social practices within a community. In the Filipino context, love was deeply embedded in societal beliefs about loyalty, emotional expression, perseverance, and destiny, and the selected songs revealed how these values guided romantic experiences, particularly among the youth.

Filipino belief in “*Tadhana*” (Destiny)

Songs such as “Estranghero,” (2022) “Pahina,” (2025) “Nag-iisang Muli,” (2019) and “Mananatili” (2022) reflected the Filipino belief in *tadhana*, or destiny, suggested that love is preordained and meaningful. The portrayal of romantic faith in these songs underscored a cultural narrative in which relationships are guided by fate and require trust in a higher, often moral, order. “Ikaw Pa Rin Ang Pipiliin Ko”, “Mananatili” and “Patutunguhan” exemplified *paninindigan* (commitment), depicting love as a deliberate and steadfast choice. The repeated declarations, such as “*Ikaw pa rin ang pipiliin ko*, (I will still choose you)”, “*Basta ako’y patungo sa’yo*” (As long as I’m coming to you) and “*Mananatili, sa iyong tabi magdamag*” (I will stay by your side all night long) conveyed unwavering devotion, loyalty, and emotional constancy. Such portrayals illustrated that in Filipino culture, true love are measured not solely by emotional intensity but by one’s willingness to remain committed despite challenges, uncertainty, or social pressures. These songs constructed an ideal of love as morally grounded, enduring, and culturally significant, emphasizing that emotional expressions are intertwined with responsibility and perseverance.

Filipino culture of “*Pagsasakripisyo*” (Self-sacrifice)

“Sagada” (2020) exemplified *sakripisyo* (sacrifice for love), portraying the selfless act of letting go for the beloved’s happiness. Here, love was not possessive but generous, aligning with Filipino ideals that emphasized altruism, moral integrity, and relational harmony. Across the body of songs, Cup of Joe demonstrated that Filipinos tend to idealized love as both emotional and moral: intense passion coexists with loyalty, patience, sacrifice, and faith in destiny. Love was presented as something worth suffering for, waiting for, and believing in, rather than fleeting or casual. Through their music, Cup of Joe not only entertained but also educated and reinforced cultural values, portraying love as an idealized, almost sacred experience where devotion, emotional sincerity, and belief in fate define the Filipino conception of perfect romance.

Filipino Courtship in Contemporary Music

Songs such as “Tingin” (2023) and “Misteryoso” (2024), foreground the traditional practice of *panliligaw*, or courtship, emphasizing patience, humility, and persistent pursuit as markers of true love. In “Tingin,” the lyrics “Di pinapansin, ingay sa tabi, magulong kapaligiran, sa’yo lang ang tingin” and “Sa ’yo nakatingin, sa ’yo lang ang tingin” depicted a steadfast focus on one person despite distractions, mirroring Filipino values of *pagiging tapat* (faithfulness) and *pagiging buo ang loob* (wholehearted commitment). Similarly, in “Misteryoso,” lines such as “Kahit pa ilaan lahat ng oras sa ’yo” (Even if I dedicate all my time to you) and “Hindi titigil hanggang ako na ang dahilan ng ’yong ngiting misteryoso” (I won't stop until I'm the reason for your mysterious smile) highlighted the cultural importance of respect, sincerity, and dedication in courtship.

Filipino Ideals on Immortalizations of love

In “Multo” (2024), the lyric “*Minumulto na ‘ko ng damdamin ko*” (I'm haunted by my feelings) exemplified the Filipino tendency to openly express vulnerability and deep sentiment in romantic contexts. The metaphor of being “haunted” by one’s feelings reflected the dramatic and poetic ways in which love and heartbreak was traditionally conveyed in Filipino music and literature. Emotional intensity was often celebrated, and suffering in love was normalized, interpreted as evidence of the depth and authenticity of one’s affection. This portrayal aligned with the cultural understanding that love was not only felt but also morally validated through enduring emotional sacrifice, demonstrating that passion and loyalty are intertwined in the Filipino imagination of ideal romance.

Justification of Results

Bamford, Vigl, Hämäläinen, and Saarikallio (2024) asserted that love constituted a prevalent theme in music worldwide, allowing listeners to derive emotional significance and connect it to their personal journeys. The findings of this research, which highlighted the expressions of Eros, Agape, and Mania, support this notion as the examined lyrics embody fervent attraction, selfless love, and obsessive attachment. These variations of love exemplified how song lyrics served as emotional stories that conveyed various aspects of romantic relationships. Moreover, Meyer (1956) found out that emotional meaning within music arises from sequences of tension and resolution, implying that lyrical content and musical composition collaborate to amplify emotional resonance. The vivid imagery, recurring phrases, and expressive language evident in the chosen lyrics bolster this concept, enriching the emotional interpretation of love within these songs.

The conclusions also aligned with Greek interpretations of love, which offered a framework for comprehending diverse emotional dynamics in connections. The presence of Eros within the lyrics signified passionate and romantic attraction, marked by emotional depth and the desire for closeness (Youvan, 2024). In contrast, the portrayal of Agape in the tracks underscored unconditional love, where the welfare of the beloved was prioritized even at personal cost (Thompson, 2024). Lyrics that conveyed acceptance and sacrifice illustrated the philosophical understanding of agape as a compassionate and ethically driven kind of love. Conversely, the depiction of Mania in certain lyrics reflected an obsessive and emotionally reliant attachment, typically linked with insecurity and fear of losing loved ones (Linter, 2024). These findings affirmed that Greek concepts of love remained relevant when analyzing modern lyrical expressions, particularly in popular music that conveyed various emotional states through poetic language.

The recurrent themes discovered in the songs—steady affection, sentimental nostalgia, and enduring presence—further substantiate earlier research on romantic idealization within youth culture. Research indicated that young individuals often romanticize

love through narratives emphasizing loyalty, sacrifice, and emotional fervor (Martín-Salvador et al., 2021). In the selected tracks, steady affection was reflected in lyrics that underlined loyalty and the commitment to choose the same partner despite barriers or hardships. This depiction of unwavering devotion corresponded with findings showing that cultural beliefs surrounding romantic commitment shaped how youth perceive relationships and emotional bonds (Ruiz-Palomino et al., 2021). Similarly, the themes of reminiscence and yearning within the lyrics enhanced the notion that romantic recollections and emotional attachment significantly influenced individuals' views on love and relationships.

The findings further emphasized the value of Original Pilipino Music (OPM) as a cultural medium for articulating romantic sentiments and values. Previous research suggested that OPM lyrics frequently reflected interpersonal bonds, affection, and emotional experiences that resonated profoundly with Filipino youth (Lano et al., n.d.). The themes uncovered in this study supported this assertion, as the analyzed songs consistently depicted love through memories, yearning, commitment, and emotional openness. Furthermore, the use of repetition, casual language, and emotive expressions in the lyrics exemplified typical linguistic features within OPM that reinforced emotional significance and accessibility for listeners (Sumbad, 2025). These stylistic traits illustrated how songwriters conveyed emotional depth while ensuring relatability for their audience.

The results also validated the application of content analysis as a viable technique for scrutinizing song lyrics. Prior research had demonstrated that qualitative scrutiny of lyrical texts could unveil figurative language, symbolism, and emotional themes woven throughout songs (Yusnitasari et al., 2022; Amri & Djuarie, 2025). In a similar vein, the analysis in this study pinpointed literary elements such as imagery, metaphor, repetition, and emotive language that contributed to the interpretation of distinct love styles and themes. These findings reinforced the assertion that song lyrics could be examined similarly to literary texts, where language and structure revealed profound insights into human emotions and relationships.

(Rizka, 2024). Through a systematic evaluation, the study successfully identified patterns of romantic expression that illustrated how lyrical content conveyed emotional narratives.

Finally, the findings underscored how music mirrors Filipino cultural values concerning love, identity, and emotional expression. Music had historically functioned as a conduit for expressing cultural identity and shared experiences, enabling individuals to recognize their own lives and values within songs (Espiritu et al., 2025). Within Filipino culture, love was frequently linked to loyalty, sacrifice, faith, and destiny, themes evident in the analyzed songs. These representations resonated with the Filipino concept of *loob* (will) , which perceived love as a deliberate and profoundly personal pledge to another (Ramos, 2025). Furthermore, music often served as a means of emotional connection and communal contemplation in Filipino society (Tabuena, 2022). Through depictions of devotion, yearning, and sacrifice, Cup of Joe's songs not only conveyed personal feelings but also reinforced cultural ideals regarding relationships and romantic dedication.

In conclusion, the findings indicated that the lyrics in Cup of Joe's songs captured both universal aspects of love and distinct Filipino cultural values. The inclusion of various love styles, recurring emotional themes, and cultural narratives highlighted how song lyrics served as significant cultural texts, influencing listeners' views on relationships and emotional experiences. Consequently, these results aligned with prior research underscoring music's potent role in emotional expression, cultural identity, and the portrayal of romantic connections.

Implication of Findings

This study's findings suggest that song lyrics can be valuable resources for education, fostering cultural understanding, and guiding future research. In an educational context, the identification of distinct love styles—Eros, Agape, and Mania—reveals that contemporary music explores intricate emotional themes, much like literary works. This allows students to delve into lyrical language,

imagery, and symbolism, thereby enhancing their comprehension of emotional expression and interpersonal dynamics (Bamford et al., 2024).

Regarding culture and society, the study underscores the significance of Original Pilipino Music (OPM) in reflecting Filipino values concerning love and relationships. The prevalent themes of unwavering affection, nostalgic reflection, and enduring presence illustrate how romantic love is often depicted through loyalty, sacrifice, and emotional dedication. These portrayals resonate with cultural beliefs about romantic commitment and idealized love among young Filipinos, reflecting values such as perseverance, sincerity, and faith in relationships, thereby reinforcing the cultural perspective of love as a deliberate and significant commitment (Martín-Salvador et al., 2021; Ruiz-Palomino et al., 2021; Ramos, 2025).

Moreover, this research contributes to the existing body of knowledge by affirming that content analysis is a robust methodology for scrutinizing emotional themes and literary techniques within song lyrics.

Previous research has demonstrated that qualitative analysis can uncover symbolism, metaphorical language, and emotional narratives hidden in songs (Yusnitasari et al., 2022; Amri & Djuharie, 2025; Rizka, 2024). Nevertheless, as few studies have concentrated on contemporary Filipino bands including Cup of Joe, this research suggests that future researchers should investigate other OPM artists, genres, and audiences to better understand how music influences emotional expression and perceptions of romantic relationships among Filipino youth.

Recommendations

Based on the findings and analysis of the songs of Cup of Joe, the following recommendations focused on improving the academic value of the study by expanding literary perspectives, increasing cultural understanding, and promoting appreciation of the different forms of love shown in contemporary Filipino music.

1. **Music Industry.** A better understanding of how different forms of love appear in song lyrics gives insight into the emotions that connect with Filipino listeners. The way love is shown in songs reflects personal feelings, relationships, and real-life experiences. This understanding helps the music industry create songs that match the emotions, stories, and cultural experiences of Filipino audiences.
2. **Filipino Culture and OPM Studies.** The findings of this study show how the songs of Cup of Joe reflect Filipino cultural values, emotional expression, and shared experiences in society. Songs in Original Pilipino Music show how love and relationships are connected to Filipino values such as care, sincerity, and strong personal connections. This also strengthens the appreciation of OPM as an important way of expressing Filipino identity and culture.
3. **Listeners of Cup of Joe.** Understanding the different forms of love found in the songs of Cup of Joe gives listeners a deeper meaning when listening to their music. The themes in the lyrics relate to personal emotions and relationship experiences. This allows listeners to connect the songs to their own life and feelings.
4. **Teachers.** Contemporary Filipino songs work as useful learning materials in school. The different forms of love found in OPM lyrics support discussions in subjects such as literature, music, and social studies. These songs also help students understand cultural values, emotions, and literary meaning.
5. **Students.** Using song lyrics as literary texts helps students improve their skills in analyzing and understanding texts. The themes of love in Filipino songs give examples that are easy for students to relate to. Familiar music also makes learning more interesting and encourages appreciation of literature and culture.
6. **Researchers.** The study adds to academic discussions about music, language, and emotions. Song lyrics in Original Pilipino Music show how love reflects real-life experiences, social values, and

relationships in Filipino society. This helps researchers better understand how music expresses feelings and cultural meaning.

7. **Future Researchers.** This study serves as a guide for future research about song lyrics, love themes, and Filipino music. Studies about other OPM artists, music genres, or different research approaches give more understanding of how love appears in Filipino songs. These studies also provide deeper knowledge about the cultural and emotional meaning found in OPM.

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APPENDICES

APPENDIX A.1

Letter to Principal



MARIST BROTHERS
NOTRE DAME OF DADIANGAS UNIVERSITY
Integrated Basic Education Department
Senior High School
Marist Avenue, 9500 General Santos City, Philippines



February 13, 2026

Principal
Notre Dame of Dadiangas University - IBED
Marist Avenue, General Santos City

Thru :
SHS Assistant Principal

Dear Br. Ernie,

Greetings of peace!

We, the Grade 11 students from HUMSS 1115, are conducting our research study entitled **CUP OF LOVE : AN ANALYSIS OF HOW LOVE IS POTRAYED ON THE SONGS OF CUP OF JOE** as a partial fulfillment of the requirement for our Practical Research 1 subject.

In line with this, We respectfully request approval to conduct our content analysis study within the school premises. The research will follow all ethical and academic standards as the study will not involve human participants. Furthermore, the researchers will strictly adhere to school policies and regulations, ensuring it does not disrupt regular activities.

We sincerely hope for you favorable consideration and support in the successful conduct of this research. Thank you very much for your time and kind consideration. Thank you and God bless!

In Notre Dame:
MA. KRISTINE REY S. ABANG
ROGER J. G. GERSAVA
RAEYANNE K. MATEO
ELTHEA TRISTDALE P. NG
RAFAEL M. WAO

REYANBELLE R. CLARIS
PRECIOUS ELEONA O. LORENZANA
KATHLYN CONCEPCION G. MORATIN
JANN RAVEN V. VALLADOLID
HAILEY M. MCOT

Noted by:
SHENNEL C. ABELLANOSA, LPT
Practical Research 1 Adviser

APPENDIX A.2

Letter to Research Adviser



MARIST BROTHERS
NOTRE DAME OF DADIANGAS UNIVERSITY
Integrated Basic Education Department
Senior High School
Marist Avenue, 9500 General Santos City, Philippines



February 2026

SHENNEI C. ABELLANOSA, LPT
Practical Research 1 Adviser
Notre Dame of Dadiangas University - IBED
Marist Avenue, General Santos City

Dear Ma'am Shennei,

Greetings of peace!

We, the Grade 11 students from HUMSS 1115, Group 4, are conducting our research study entitled **CUP OF LOVE : AN ANALYSIS OF HOW LOVE IS POTRAYED ON THE SONGS OF CUP OF JOE** as a partial fulfillment of the requirement for our Practical Research 1 subject.

In line with this, we respectfully request permission to conduct our study through content analysis inside the school premises. We assure your good office that this study shall strictly adhere to the ethical standards of research. This research will not involve human participants, and all materials will be used only for academic purposes with proper acknowledgment of sources.

We sincerely hope for you favorable consideration and support in the successful conduct of this research. Thank you very much for your time and kind consideration. Thank you and God bless!

In Notre Dame,
MA. KRISTINE REY S. ABANG
ROGER M. G. GERSAVA
RAEYANNE K. MATEO
ELTHEA TRYSDALE P. NG
RAFAEL W. WAO

REYAHBELLE R. CLAPIS
PRECIOUS ELEONA O. LORENZANA
KATHLYN CONCEPCION G. MORATIN
JANN RAVEN V. VALLADOLID
HAILEY M. GUT

Approved by:
SHENNEI C. ABELLANOSA, LPT
Practical Research 1 Adviser

APPENDIX A.3

Letter to the Research Expert



MARIST BROTHERS
NOTRE DAME OF DADIANGAS UNIVERSITY
Integrated Basic Education Department
Senior High School
Marist Avenue, 9500 General Santos City, Philippines



January 2026
Charisse P. Sumalinog, MA-LIT, LPT
Research Expert
Notre Dame of Dadiangas University – IBED
Lagao, General Santos City

Dear Ma'am Charisse,

Greetings of Peace!

We the researchers of Group 4 from HUMSS 1115 are conducting our qualitative research entitled **"CUP OF LOVE : AN ANALYSIS OF HOW LOVE IS POTRAYED ON THE SONGS OF CUP OF JOE** as partial fulfillment for our Practical Research 1.

In this regard, we respectfully request your assistance as a **Research Expert** to review our research, in terms of clarity, relevance, and suitability to our study. Your suggestions and recommendations will greatly help improve the quality of our research.

We sincerely hope for your favorable response. Thank you and God Bless!

In Notre Dames

MA.. KRISTINE REY S. ABANG

ROGER IL G. GERSAVA

RAEYANNE KIL MATEO

ELTHEA TRYSDALE P.P NG

RAFAEL W. WAO

REYAHBELLE R. CLAPIS

PRECIOUS ELEONA GO. LORENZANA

KATHLYN CONCEPCION G. MORATIN

JANN RAVEN V. VALLADOLID

HAILEY M. NGOT

Noted By:

SHENDEL C. ABELLANOSA, LPT
Practical Research 1 Adviser

Approved by:

CHARISSE P. SUMALINOG, MA-LIT, LPT
Research Expert

APPENDIX A.4

Letter to the Validator



MARIST BROTHERS
NOTRE DAME OF DADIANGAS UNIVERSITY
Integrated Basic Education Department
Senior High School
Marist Avenue, 9500 General Santos City, Philippines



January 2026
Charisse P. Sumalinog, MA-LIT, LPT
Research Validator
Notre Dame of Dadiangas University – IBED
Lagao, General Santos City

Dear Ma'am,

Greetings of Peace!

We the researchers of Group 4 from HUMSS 1115 are conducting our qualitative research entitled **"CUP OF LOVE : AN ANALYSIS OF HOW LOVE IS POTRAYED ON THE SONGS OF CUP OF JOE"** as partial fulfillment for our Practical Research 1.

In line with this, we would like to ask for your assistance in validating our Chapter 1,2, and 3. Your assistance would be highly appreciated and would be a significantly reliable research approach.

We sincerely hope for your favorable response. Thank you and God Bless!

In Notre Dame,

MA.. KRISTINE REY S. ABANG	REYABELLE R. CLAPIS
ROGER H. G. GERSAVA	PRECIOUS ELEONA O. LORENZANA
RAEYANNE K.K. MATEO	KATHLYN CONCEPCION G. MORATIN
ELTHEA TRYSDALE P. NG	JANN RAVEN V. VALLADOLID
RAFAEL W. WAO	HAILEY M. NGOT

Noted By:
SHENNEL C. ABELANOSA, LPT
Practical Research 1 Adviser

Approved by:
CHARISSE P. SUMALINOG, MA-LIT, LPT
Research Validator

APPENDIX A.5

Letter to the Grammarian



MARIST BROTHERS
NOTRE DAME OF DADIANGAS UNIVERSITY
Integrated Basic Education Department
Senior High School
Marist Avenue, 9500 General Santos City, Philippines



January 2026
Eve Marie Ronna D. Masongsong, LPT
Grammarian
Notre Dame of Dadiangas University – IBED
Lagao, General Santos City

Dear Ma'am,

Greetings of Peace!

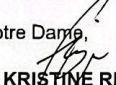
We the researchers of Group 4 from HUMSS 1115 are conducting our qualitative research entitled **"CUP OF LOVE : AN ANALYSIS OF HOW LOVE IS POTRAYED ON THE SONGS OF CUP OF JOE"** as partial fulfillment for our Practical Research 1.

In line with this, we respectfully request your assistance as the **Grammarian** of our study.

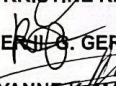
Your expertise in reviewing the grammar, clarity, and language of our manuscript will greatly help improve the quality of our research. Your contribution will be properly acknowledged.

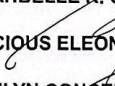
We sincerely hope for your favorable response. Thank you and God Bless!

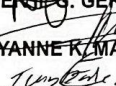
In Notre Dame,

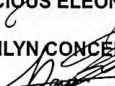

MA.. KRISTINE REY S. ABANG

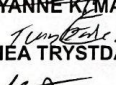

REYANBELLE R. CLAPIS

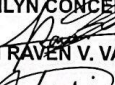

ROGERSIL G. GERSAVA

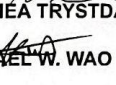

PRECIOUS ELEONA O. LORENZANA

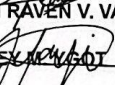

RAEYANNE K. MATEO


KATHLYN CONCEPCION G. MORATIN


ELTHEA TRYSDALE P. NG


JANN RAVEN V. VALLADOLID


RAFAEL W. WAO


HAILEY M. VASOT

Noted By:


SHENNEL C. ABELLANOSA, LPT
Practical Research 1 Adviser

Approved by:


EVE MARIE RONNA D. MASONGSONG, LPT
Grammarian

APPENDIX A.6

Letter to the Band



MARIST BROTHERS
NOTRE DAME OF DADIANGAS UNIVERSITY
Integrated Basic Education Department
Senior High School
Marist Avenue, 9500 General Santos City, Philippines



January 2026
Cup of Joe
Quezon City, Philippines

Dear Members of Cup of Joe,

Greetings of Peace!

We, the researchers of HUMSS 1115 Group 4 from the **Integrated Basic Education Department (Senior High School) of Notre Dame of Dadiangas University**, located in **Lagao, General Santos City, Philippines**, respectfully submit this request in connection with our academic research.

The researchers will conduct a study entitled **"CUP OF LOVE : AN ANALYSIS OF HOW LOVE IS POTRAYED ON THE SONGS OF CUP OF JOE."** The study has been accepted to further understand themes such as love, emotion, and personal experience in contemporary Filipino music, and to examine their relevance in youth culture and OPM.

In line with our commitment to ethical research and respect for intellectual property, we are formally requesting your documented consent with the understanding that the researchers may:

- a. Use limited excerpts from the selected songs for academic purposes only;
- b. Include critical analysis, interpretation, and scholarly discussion of the works; and
- c. Present the completed research paper to the Faculty of the Senior High School Department of Notre Dame of Dadiangas University – IBED as a course requirement for **Practical Research 1**.

The researchers shall not:

- a. Publish, distribute, or share the songs or lyrics in any form for profit;
- b. Modify, alter, or adapt the songs beyond the context of academic analysis.



MARIST BROTHERS
NOTRE DAME OF DADIANGAS UNIVERSITY
Integrated Basic Education Department
Senior High School
Marist Avenue, 9500 General Santos City, Philippines



This research acknowledges that the study may present both benefits and risks to the researchers and the artists. Benefits may include proper recognition of the band's work, educational use, acknowledgment in the research paper, and contributions to future studies, while risks may involve exposure to academic critique or interpretation of the thematic content.

If Cup of Joe chooses not to approve the use of any songs, the researchers will exclude them from the study and ensure that the paper is neither uploaded, published, nor shared publicly. This document serves as formal acknowledgment that both parties understand and agree to these terms, and that proper credit will be given according to the band's decision. We sincerely appreciate your consideration and support of academic research in the arts and humanities.

We sincerely thank you for your time, consideration, and support of academic inquiry in the arts and humanities.

In Notre Dame

MA. KRISTINE REY S. ABANG

ROGER H. G. GERSAVA

RAEYANNE K. MATEO

ELTHEA TRYSDALE P. NG

RAFAEL W. WAO

REYAHBELLE R. CLAPIS

PRECIOUS ELEDNA O. LORENZANA

KATHLYN CONCEPCION G. MORATIN

JANN RAVEN V. VALLADOLID

HAILEY M. YEOT

Noted By

SHENNET C. ABELLANOSA, LPT
Practical Research 1 Adviser

APPENDIX B

Certificate of Research Expert



MARIST BROTHERS
NOTRE DAME OF DADIANGAS UNIVERSITY
Integrated Basic Education Department
Senior High School
Marist Avenue, 9500 General Santos City, Philippines



CERTIFICATION

This is to certify that I, **Charisse P. Sumalinog, MA-LIT, LPT** have reviewed and evaluated the research paper entitled:

"CUP OF LOVE: AN ANALYSIS OF HOW LOVE IS PORTRAYED ON THE SONGS OF CUP OF JOE"

Conducted by **ABANG, MA. KRISTINE REY S., CLAPIS, REYAHBELLE R., GERSAVA, ROGER II G., LORENZANA, PRECIOUS ELEONA O., MATEO, RAEYANNE K., MORATIN, KATHLYN CONCEPTION G., NG, ELTHEA TRYSDALE P., VALLADOLID, JANN RAVEN D., WAO, RAFAEL S., and YGOT, HAILEY M., of HUMSS 1115.**

After a thorough examination of the manuscript's research framework, methodology, and overall scholarly quality, I hereby affirm that the study demonstrates academic rigor, logical coherence, and methodological soundness appropriate for the level of research being undertaken.

This certification is issued in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the subject **Practical Research 1**.

Issued this **8th of April 2026** at **Notre Dame of Dadiangas University–Integrated Basic Education Department Lagao**.


Charisse P. Sumalinog, MA-LIT, LPT
Research Expert
Notre Dame of Dadiangas University
Senior High School Department

APPENDIX C

Certificate of Validation



MARIST BROTHERS
NOTRE DAME OF DADIANGAS UNIVERSITY
Integrated Basic Education Department
Senior High School
Marist Avenue, 9500 General Santos City, Philippines



CERTIFICATE OF VALIDATION

This is to certify that I have received and reviewed the following research instrument(s) to be used in the data collection for the group study of the following students:

ABANG, MA. KRISTINE REY S., CLAPIS, REYAHBELLE R., GERSAVA, ROGER II G., LORENZANA, PRECIOUS ELEONA O., MATEO, RAEYANNE K., MORATIN, KATHLYN CONCEPTION G., NG, ELTHEA TRYSDALE P., VALLADOLID, JANN RAVEN D., WAO, RAFAEL S., and YGOT, HAILEY M.

Research Instrument(s):

1. Coding Matrix

After thorough evaluation, the aforementioned research instrument(s) was/were found to possess **content validity** appropriate for the study's objectives.

This certification is hereby issued for the purpose of fulfilling the research study requirements in **Practical Research 1**.

Issued this **8th of April 2026** at **Notre Dame of Dadiangas University–Integrated Basic Education Department Lagao**.

4
Charisse P. Sumalinog, MA-LIT, LPT
Research Validator
Notre Dame of Dadiangas University
Senior High School Department

APPENDIX D

Formulated Meaning

Table 1. Forms of Love Expressed in the Selected COJ songs

Form of Love	Lyrical Evidence	Formalistic Element	Interpretation
Eros	<i>“Di pinapansin, ingay sa tabi, magulong kapaligiran, sa’yo lang ang tingin”</i> (Tingin, 2025) (Ignoring noise nearby, chaotic surroundings, only looking at you)	Imagery and Contrast	The chaotic surroundings emphasize that the speaker’s attention is solely on the beloved, showing intense romantic focus.
Eros	<i>“Muli kitang kikilalanin, minamahal kong estranghero”</i> (Estranghero, 2025) (I will meet you again, my dear stranger)	Emotive Diction and Tone	The lyrics reflect romantic determination and longing, highlighting emotional intensity and desire to reconnect with the beloved.
Eros	<i>“Ano mang takbo ng panahon, kahit na ako’y biglang matangay, wala mang himlay, basta ako’y patungo sa’yo”</i> (Patutunguhan, 2025) (No matter how time passes, even if I’m suddenly swept away, there’s no rest, as long as I’m heading towards you.	Imagery, Hyperbole	The lyrics convey passionate longing and determination to be with the beloved despite obstacles, reflecting deep romantic desire.

Eros	<i>“Ang kahilingang mahanap kita, ang tanging hangad ng puso’y ikaw”</i> (Nag-iisang Muli, 2023) <i>(The wish to find you, you are the only desire of my heart)</i>	Repetition, Emotive Diction	Repetition of exclusive desire emphasizes the speaker’s longing and emotional devotion toward the beloved.
Eros	<i>“Ang natatanging kagandahang nababalot ng hiwagang humahalina sa akin”</i> (Misteryoso, 2022) <i>(A unique beauty shrouded in mystery fascinates me)</i>	Metaphor and Imagery	The beloved’s beauty is mysterious and captivating, portraying romantic attraction and intense emotional fascination.
Agape	<i>“Ikaw pa rin ang pipiliin, ikaw ang pipiliin ko”</i> (Ikaw Pa Rin Ang Pipiliin Ko, 2025) <i>(I will still choose you; you will be my choice)</i>	Repetition and Emotive Diction	Shows selfless and unconditional love, emphasizing devotion and repeatedly choosing the beloved despite uncertainty.
Agape	<i>“Mananatili, hindi tiyak ang bukas natin, ngunit itong gabi ay atin”</i> (Mananatili, 2025) <i>(Stay, tomorrow is uncertain, but this night is ours)</i>	Tone, Imagery	Reflects love freely given in the present moment, valuing devotion without expectation.
Agape	<i>“Iyong tandaan na ako’y masayang</i>	Emotive Diction and Tone	Demonstrates sacrificial love, prioritizing the beloved’s well-

	<i>ika'y malaya na"</i> (Sagada, 2025) (Remember that I am happy you are free)		being over personal feelings.
Agape	<i>"Ikaw pa rin ang patutunguhan"</i> (Patutunguhan, 2025) (You are still the direction)	Imagery and Metaphor	Emphasizes patient and guided commitment, highlighting support, stability, and intentional love.
Agape	<i>"Hanggang sa dulo ng walang hanggan, Ikaw ang hanggan"</i> (Nag- iisang Muli, 2023) (Until the end of eternity, you are the limit)	Hyperbole and Emotive Diction	Shows enduring, unconditional devotion that transcends beyond time, circumstances or personal gain.
Mania	<i>"Minumulto na 'ko ng damdamin ko"</i> (Multo, 2023) (My feelings are haunting me)	Hyperbole, Imagery	Shows obsessive and emotionally unstable love, reflecting deep attachment and inability to let go. The overwhelming longing highlights the intense and dependent nature of Mania.
Mania	<i>"Mga sana'y 'di mabilang, Hinahanap-hanap, tamis ng nakaraan, Ba't tinatalikuran?"</i> (Estranghero,2023)	Repetition, Emotive Diction	Expresses fixation on past moments and emotional dependence. Mania is reflected through anxiety, longing, and possessiveness, showing love driven by need

	(Countless 'what ifs' I keep longing for the sweetest past, why turning back?)		rather than balance.
Mania	<i>"Sa lahat ng pahinang sinulat ng tadhana'y ikaw at ikaw pa rin"</i> (Pahina, 2022) (In all the pages written by fate, it's you, and you, and always you)	Repetition, Hyperbole	Demonstrates obsessive thoughts and emotional highs and lows. Mania is evident in the singer's intense fixation, emotional overwhelm, and fear of losing the beloved.

Table 1. Steadfast affection

Song	Lyrical Evidence	Justification
Tingin	<i>“Sa’yo lang magpapaangkin, ‘di palalampasin”</i> (I will claim only you, I will not miss it)	The line shows faithfulness because it expresses exclusive commitment. “<i>Sa’yo lang</i>” (only yours) highlights loyalty to one person, while “<i>‘di palalampasin</i>” (will not let pass) shows determination to hold on. Together, they reflect devotion and a firm choice to stay.
Patutunguhan	<i>“Mahal, ikaw lang, ang nakikita ng bulag kong paningin ikaw lang, ang ilaw sa dilim”</i> (Love, only you, my blind eyes see only you, the light in the darkness)	The metaphor “<i>bulag kong paningin</i>” (my blind sight) implies that even when the speaker feels confused, or unable to see clearly, they are still able to recognize and choose the same person. This highlights constancy even in times of uncertainty, their love and faithfulness do not change.
Ikaw Pa Rin Ang Pipiliin Ko	<i>“Kahit ika’y mapalayo sa piling ko, ikaw pa rin ang pipiliin ko”</i> (Even if you are far from me, I will still choose you)	The repeated phrase “<i>kahit</i>” (even if) shows many possible challenges. Yet the singer swears “<i>Ikaw pa rin ang pipiliin ko</i>” (I will still choose you). Emphasizes loyalty to stay even in possible times for hardship. Highlighting faithfulness.

Pahina	<i>“Sa lahat ng pahinang sinulat ng tadhana’y, ikaw at ikaw at ikaw pa rin”</i> (In all the pages written by fate, you and you and still you)	The repetition of the line <i>“ikaw at ikaw at ikaw pa rin”</i> (you and you and still you) highlights that no one else takes the place of the beloved. The repetition strengthens the idea that the speaker remains focused on only one person.
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Table 2. Sentimental Reflection

Song	Lyrical Evidence	Justification
Multo	<i>“Hindi na makalaya, dinadalaw mo 'ko bawat gabi”</i> (“Can’t be free, you visit me every night”)	This repetition mirrors how nostalgic memory loops endlessly. Formally, the structure traps the listener in the same cycle, just as the speaker is trapped in the past. Nostalgia is reinforced through this structural insistence — the past is relived night after night.
Estranghero	<i>“Hinahanap-hanap, tamis ng nakaraan, ba’t tinatalikuran?”</i> (“Are you longing for the sweetness of the past, but are you abandoning it?”)	The line indicates the theme of nostalgia as the singer states of looking at the sweetness of the past, yet the other person abandons it. As such, this falls under nostalgia since the song talks about becoming strangers, yet it explicitly states looking at the past that was once beautiful, therefore falling under the theme of nostalgia.

Ikaw Pa Rin Ang Pipiliin Ko	<i>"Ako'y nag-iisang muli hawak ang alaala mo"</i> ("I am alone again holding your memory")	The singer expresses being alone once again while still holding on to the memory of the beloved. This reflects nostalgia, as the emotions are centered on remembering the memories of being in love, showing a sentimental attachment to the past, therefore falling into the theme of nostalgia.
Pahina	<i>"Bawat buklat ng aklat, binabalikan"</i> ("Every page of the book, revisited")	The singer uses a book as a metaphor. The page represents the memories that were once shared by the beloved. With the word, "revisited", this fits nostalgia as it goes back to remembering each moment like reading back in a chapter of a book.
Sagada	<i>"Sa langit na ikaw ay muling matanaw"</i> ("In heaven you will be seen again")	This reflects nostalgia because the singer holds onto the memory of the beloved and expresses sentiment for the presence of the past relationship, which falls under the theme of nostalgia.

Table 3. Lingering presence

Song	Lyrical Evidence	Justification
Tingin	<i>“Sa’yo lang magpapaangkin, ‘di palalampasin wag ka sanang kumawala”</i> (“I will let myself belong only to you; I won’t let this pass—please don’t slip away.”)	The lyrics embody longing as a powerful emotional state marked by inclusivity, urgency, and vulnerability. The speaker expresses a willingness to belong to only one person, which shows deep attachment rather than casual attraction.
Estranghero	<i>“Kasama ka ngunit ba’t nangungulila pa rin?”</i> (“You are with me, yet why do I still feel lonely?”)	This emotional vulnerability reflects a deep yearning for the love to continue instead of fading away. The singer acknowledges the presence of the other person, yet the singer still longs for the emotional connection.
Ikaw Pa Rin Ang Pipiliin ko	<i>“Kahit ika’y mapalayo sa piling ko, ikaw pa rin ang pipiliin ko”</i> (“Even if you are far away from my side, I will still choose you.”)	This lasting devotion, despite separation, reflects a deep yearning for someone who is absent but still deeply loved. The lines express longing because they show fear of the relationship ending and everything turning into nothing. This vulnerability reflects a deep yearning for the love to continue instead of fading away.

Pahina	<i>“Nais na maramdaman muli, kung pa’no isulat ang pangalan mo”</i> (“I long to feel again what it is like to write your name.”)	These lines express how the speaker still thinks about the person over and over again and cannot move on. That’s why it shows longing. The singer longs to feel once again the name of the beloved.
Nag-iisang Muli	<i>“Ang tanging hangad ng puso’y ikaw”</i> (“You are the heart’s only longing.”)	The singer shows longing as it explicitly states that the beloved only belongs to them alone. It also puts emphasis on longing for their presence, which it falls under longing.
Misteryoso	<i>“Nais masilayan ang iyong mga matang, puno ng lihim at ng kislap”</i> (“It longs to gaze upon your eyes, Filled with secrets and a sparkling light”)	It falls under longing because the speaker expresses a deep desire to see the other person’s eyes, showing yearning for closeness. The song highlights an intense wish to experience something meaningful and intimate.
Patutunguhan	<i>“Ako’y sumasalungat na sa alon, nakatuon sa ‘yong direksyon”</i> (“I am going against the waves, focused on your direction.”)	It shows longing because it uses metaphor to communicate a strong emotional pull toward someone despite obstacles. The singer is pushing through difficulty or resistance, and the fact that they do this is because their desire for the other person is stronger than anything else around them.

APPENDIX E

Certificate of Research Editing



MARIST BROTHERS
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Integrated Basic Education Department
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CERTIFICATE OF RESEARCH EDITING

This is to certify that **EVE MARIE RONNA D. MASONGSONG** has served as a **Research Grammarian** for the research study titled **CUP OF LOVE: AN ANALYSIS OF HOW LOVE IS POTRAYED ON THE SONGS OF CUP OF JOE** authored by **ABANG, MA. KRISTINE REY S., CLAPIS, REYAHBELLE R., GERSAVA, ROGER II G., LORENZANA, PRECIOUS ELEONA O., MATEO, RAEYANNE K., MORATIN, KATHLYN CONCEPTION G., NG, ELTHEA TRYSDALE P., VALLADOLID, JANN RAVEN D., WAO, RAFAEL S., and YGOT, HAILEY M.** of **HUMSS 1115** in fulfillment of the requirements for **Practical Research 1**.

This certificate is awarded in recognition of the grammarian's valuable contribution in ensuring the accuracy, clarity, and scholarly quality of the research manuscript.

Given this **10th of April 2026** at **Notre Dame of Dadiangas University-Integrated Basic Education Department Lagao**.


EVE MARIE RONNA D. MASONGSONG

Name and Signature of Editor

Licensed Professional Teacher

Highest Degree/Credential

April 10, 2026

Date

Noted by:


SHENNET C. ABELLANOSA, LPT

Research Adviser

April 10, 2026

Date

APPENDIX F

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APPENDIX G

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AI Tool Used	Encoded Prompts	AI Generated Statement Tracker (Page no./Page nos.)	Researchers' Review and Modification Process/es
ChatGPT	-Translate all the lyrics into english		• Double checking each translated lyrics once after it was translated to english to ensure accuracy.
Quillbot	-For paraphrasing certain quotations from citations and paragraphs, such as ethical considerations.		• Proofreading each paragraph to ensure ideas from the original creator of published works are credited and not plagiarized. • Paraphrasing further to ensure accuracy,
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Student Acknowledgement

By signing this declaration form, I/we confirm that any AI-generated output was properly reviewed, modified, edited, and cited.

Research Title: CUP OF LOVE AN ANALYSIS OF HOW LOVE IS PORTRAYED ON THE SONGS OF CUP OF JOE

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